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Justin Adler

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

SUMMARY

Senior .NET Cloud Architect and Engineer with 15+ years across real estate, fintech and automotive - from early-stage startups to international consultancies. Deep expertise in the Microsoft stack (.NET FF to .NET 10), Azure/AWS and distributed backend systems. Comfortable owning the full stack of technical leadership: architecture, team building, delivery and client engagement. A hands-on lead who stays close to the tools - I contribute technically while driving architecture, delivery and team growth.

What I bring: faster delivery through tight, repeatable processes. Healthy codebases built on solid engineering standards. Cloud infrastructure that's right-sized and cost-efficient. A team culture that fosters growth and continuous learning.

Experience

Technology Lead - Syion.com (Australia + Singapore)

May 2024 - Nov 2025

> Brought in to provide technical leadership across a team with some fragmented process. Defined engineering standards, modernised legacy .NET infrastructure and introduced delivery frameworks that improved both output quality and team cohesion. Hands-on across the full stack - from infrastructure and tooling through to code quality and delivery process - while having to maintain close client relationships and accountability for project outcomes.

- Organised 10 engineers across concurrent client projects using SCRUM - decomposed product requirements into JIRA tickets with estimates, descriptions and acceptance criteria; ran fortnightly sprints with grooming and retros
- Modernised two legacy automotive dealership platforms from .NET Framework 4.6.2 to .NET 8; introduced Docker + docker-compose for a consistent local dev experience; cleaned up a fragmented multi-repo git process into a single-repo workflow; added New Relic for APM and error visibility
- Started using serverless AWS services for newer projects - .NET 8 with SNS, Lambda or App-Runner
- Cut AWS spend by ~45% ($11K/month down to ~$6K/month) with further savings still available - eliminated over-provisioned resources and reduced dev environment costs to near-zero via a custom Slack commands that spins up resources on demand with an automatic 1-hour teardown
- Led on-site client engagement: requirements gathering, quoting, milestone tracking and prioritisation - serving as the primary technical point of contact

- Elevated team capability through enforced PR + test review gates, coding standards and internal demos (e.g. hands-on Docker/docker-compose technical sessions)

💻 Stack: AWS - EC2, SNS, SES, Amplify, Lambda, Cognito, RDS, S3, IAM, App-Runner, Route 53; Cloudflare

💎 Skills: C#, ASP.NET, .NET Framework, AWS, ASP.NET Core, Microsoft SQL, Technical Leadership, Solution Architecture, Mentoring, SCRUM process

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homely

Senior Software Engineer - Homely.com.au (Australia)

2013 - May 2024

> Led the engineering team (up to ~8 developers) through a significant period of growth and modernisation - including a product pivot and rebrand from StreetAdvisor and a full migration from on-premises infrastructure to Azure.

- Architected and owned the migration from on-prem to Azure, selecting and implementing services across App Services, Azure Functions, Storage (and AWS S3), Azure Cloud Services (now obsolete), Azure VM's
- Built and maintained a high-availability ingestion pipeline processing tens of thousands of listing files per day from ~80 real estate customer integrations - zero planned downtime tolerance
- Delivered and maintained new premium features (property listings, agent finder, background processes like listing expiry, push notifications, etc.) with .NET and Azure App Services and Azure Functions
- Established observability and monitoring practices using Application Insights and broader Azure monitoring tooling
- Drove adoption of containerisation and modern deployment practices to simplify deployment and local development
- Led cross-functional agile ceremonies - standups, sprint planning, and retrospectives
- Mentored junior and mid-level developers; owned onboarding end-to-end for new engineering hires
- Conducted engineering hiring interviews and contributed to team growth decisions
- Owned code quality across the team — establishing review standards, setting technical direction through PRs + CI/CD and maintaining a consistent engineering standard as the team and codebase grew.

💻 Stack: Azure - App Services, Functions, Azure Sql, Storage, Container Apps and Registries, Application Insights, Entra ID (previously Azure AD), Web Application Firewall, Cloud Services (now obsolete), Azure Cache for Redis, Virtual Machines, Virtual Networks and Subscriptions; Cloudflare; GitHub; Azure DevOps; Elastic Cloud; AWS - S3

💎 Skills: C# / ASP.NET Core, Microsoft SQL, ASP.NET / .NET Full Framework, Technical Leadership, Solution Architecture, Mentoring, SCRUM process

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StreetAdvisor

Senior Software Engineer - StreetAdvisor (Australia)

2007 - 2013

> As the founding engineer on StreetAdvisor, I architected and built the platform from the ground up - writing the first line of code through to production. Everything outside of the frontend was mine to

> design, build, and own. Over time I grew and led the engineering team, carrying that technical leadership through to the product's pivot and rebrand as Homely.com.au.

- Built the core platform end-to-end (everything outside of the frontend) - APIs, data, infrastructure, and back-of-house systems
- Engineered suburb and agent autocomplete targeting sub-100ms response times, built on .NET and RavenDB
- Designed and maintained all infrastructure across its full evolution - from on-premises servers, to co-located hosting, to Azure. Built the business case for cloud migration, cutting server provisioning time from days to minutes and reducing monthly infrastructure costs by ~60%
- Implemented geospatial suburb mapping including point-in-polygon, WGS84 coordinate handling, and early MS SQL geospatial tooling - enabling inline maps to display administrative boundaries and street polygons
- Wore multiple hats across project management, scrum master, and business analyst - collaborating with product owners to translate business requirements into clearly defined development initiatives delivered to production

💻 Stack: Azure - Web Apps (now App Services), Functions, Storage, Cloud Services (now obsolete), Virtual Machines, Virtual Networks and Subscriptions; GitHub; Azure DevOps; AWS - S3

💎 Skills: C# / ASP.NET / .NET Full Framework, Microsoft SQL, Technical Leadership, Solution Architecture, SCRUM process

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Software Engineer - Stargate Group (Australia)

> As the founding and sole engineer on NetVal.com.au, I designed and built Australia's first online property valuation portal from scratch — taking valuations that previously took over a week down to a day or two. Alongside NetVal, I contributed to World Originate, a non-bank mortgage lending platform, handling BAU development and infrastructure.

- Founded and built NetVal.com.au — Australia's first online property valuation portal — reducing valuation turnaround from over a week to one to two days
- Contributed to defining the LIXI Valuations data standard, improving inter-company data communication across the property and lending industry
- Managed on-premises DevOps infrastructure for World Originate, an independent property loan management platform
- BAU development and feature delivery for World Originate — including a migration from VB.NET to C# / .NET, and introduction of automated testing and code quality guardrails

💻 Stack: On-Prem then Co-Located: Windows Server / IIS; BitBucket

💎 Skills: C# / ASP.NET / .NET Full Framework, Microsoft SQL

Technical Skills

BACKEND & APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT

- C# / .NET Full Framework to .NET 10
- RESTful API design
- Scalable microservices, inter-service communication, resiliency patterns, CQRS
- Event-driven systems (Azure Service Bus / RabbitMQ, Azure Event Grid)

CLOUD & DEVOPS ENGINEERING

- Azure: Functions, App Service, Container Apps and Registries, Service Bus, Event Grid, Storage, KeyVault, FrontDoor and WAF, Application Insights, VMs, Virtual Networks, Subscriptions
- AWS: S3, EC2, Lambda, Amplify, CloudWatch, DynamoDB, RDS
- Containerisation (Docker / docker-compose)
- CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins)

DATA ARCHITECTURE & STORAGE

- Relational Databases (MS SQL & PostgreSQL) - design, performance tuning, data security
- Non-Relational Databases (CosmosDB, RavenDB, MongoDB)
- Redis (caching strategies)
- ElasticSearch (search indexing & optimisation)

OBSERVABILITY & PRODUCTION ENGINEERING

- Azure Monitor, Seq, New Relic, Sentry
- Structured logging & monitoring
- Open Telemetry (OTel with Azure App Insights)
- Production incident diagnosis & optimisation

SECURITY & IDENTITY

- Azure Entra, Auth0, Okta, Identity Server
- Secure authentication & authorisation design (OAuth)
- API security best practices (OWASP, Dependabot, Snyk)

AI-AUGMENTED DEVELOPMENT

- Claude.ai
- GitHub Copilot (local and cloud controlled)
- OpenCode

TOOLING & SCRIPTING

- GitHub, Azure DevOps, JIRA, Slack, Teams
- PowerShell & Bash
- Postman

Portfolio

- Homely.com.au
- HttpClient.Helpers
- SimpleAzure.Storage.HybridQueues
- SimpleObservability
- SimpleTestcontainers.xUnit.v3
- OpenRealEstate

Education

Bachelor of Applied Science (Computer Science)
RMIT University

Secondary Education
Geelong Grammar School